

Google's indoor maps

Google Maps' app for Android has been updated to include the mapping of interiors of various stores for easier shopping

**Xbox Live goes down**

Xbox Live went down on November 16th, with a massive number of users reporting an error message citing Error 807b01f7

Updates to existing OSes, new phone launches and more...

This month we start off with some sales figures to tell you who is standing where, followed by the plethora of phone and tablet launches

Big things have come to pass in the mobile world, yet things still stand precariously at a standstill. Windows Phone 8 is here, and it has been met with mostly positive reviews, once again bemoaning the lack of a sufficiently vibrant ecosystem – something any platform apart from Android and iOS will always have to grapple with, in the hearts of consumers (and reviewers).

Market Figures

The other platforms aren't sitting idle however, with Google making many strong moves to give its platform a stronger grip on the market – in the third quarter of 2012, Android held a 72.4 per cent market share, with its next closest competitor, iOS, at 13.9 per cent, followed by BlackBerry OS, Bada, Symbian, and Windows Phone.

In terms of manufacturers, there hasn't been much change in the rankings, with Samsung once again selling the most mobile phones (smartphones and feature phones) in Q3 2012 – holding a 22.9 per cent market share. Nokia holds a 19.2 per cent share at second place, while Apple comes in at third with an always astonishing (considering it only makes smartphones) 5.5 per cent. ZTE, LG, Huawei, TCL, Research In Motion, Motorola, and HTC complete the top ten manufacturers.



Android 4.2 Jelly Bean

Android adoption figures are once again through the roof, with KPCB analyst May Meeker revealing that it is growing at least six times faster than Apple's iPhone. The analyst further revealed the number of Internet-enabled Android devices shipped had gone past the number of Internet-enabled Windows devices in Q1 2012. That was when about 90 million units of Android devices shipped per quarter. Meeker expects shipping of about 160 million units of Android devices with 100 million Windows devices and 80 million iOS devices per quarter by 2013.

According to Meeker's research, there will be about 1 billion smartphone users, but 5 billion mobile phone users by 2012-end, highlighting

the growing popularity of budget feature phones.

Google Android 4.2 Jelly Bean

Google had shown the world just what Android is capable of (in terms of intuitiveness and responsiveness) with the Android 4.1 Jelly Bean update. Now it has once again upped the ante with the Android 4.2 Jelly Bean update, that further refines the much smoother OS, and adds security features.

Improvements include built-in Swype-like gestures for typing, multiple user accounts, improved Panorama (Photo Sphere), lock-screen widgets and wireless media streaming. The new security features ensure that users can safely sideload apps from sources other than the Google Play store, by checking the app for potentially 'harmful behaviour.' There is also a new apps permission-screen, as well as a scanning feature that detects any attempt by an app to send a text message to a known fee-collecting short code.

LG E960 Nexus 4

The company also unveiled the very exciting LG-made Nexus 4 smartphone, a device that is being looked forward to for its top-end performance at great value for money (\$299 for 8 GB,

\$349 for 16 GB). Unfortunately, not every region will enjoy a low retail price for the Nexus 4, with a price range of \$549 to \$699 (₹28,000 to ₹36,000) expected outside of certain markets where the Google Play hardware store is accessible.

The LG Nexus 4 runs on a quad-core 1.5 GHz Krait Snapdragon S4 Pro coupled with the Adreno 320 GPU and 2 GB of RAM. It sports a 4.7-inch 1280x768 pixel True HD IPS Plus display with Gorilla Glass 2, an 8 MP autofocus camera with LED flash, a 1.3 MP front-facing camera, a 2,100 mAh battery and DC-HSDPA (42 Mbps) connectivity. It has no microSD card-slot, one of the only glaring missing features. It also lacks LTE which is surprising for a flagship device. The phone (at the time of writing) is currently available via eBay India and online retailers such as Saholic. It is expected to be announced by the end of November.



Google Nexus 4